

PUBLIC ART / 2024 / CHICAGO, IL

Jardin de Gargolas

YolloCalli Arts Reach



Student designed garden gargoyles taken from 3D model to cast aluminum sculpture.

THE WORK

Little Village teens with Yollocalli Arts Reach, the youth art program of the National Museum of Mexican Art, designed their own garden gargoyles in 3D software, with artist Secret of Manna. The idea grew from a rainwater garden and a bird bath, and the gargoyles are destined for Jardin Malinalli, the museum's youth garden in Pilsen and Little Village.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

A file on a screen had to become a permanent metal object, true to what each student made, and the students had to understand the process well enough to design for it.

THE MAKING

The class came to the shop first. We showed them how their 3D prints would become molds and how metal would be poured, and poured a tiny demonstration mold that day. What they brought back for the real pour was really impressive. We printed the sculptures in house as positives for a resin bonded sand mold, a lost PLA process, then cast in aluminum, welded, and finished in a dark patina. We cast one early for a big reveal: everyone had seen the prints, but seeing it in metal was something else. The rest took about a week to cast.

IN PLACE

Unveiled in April 2024 in the museum courtyard, part of the exhibition New Age Grotesque. Each gargoyle sat on its own pedestal in a small garden of flowers, each given its own space and all displayed as equals.

DETAILS

Year

2024

Location

Chicago, IL

Category

Public Art

Materials

Cast aluminum, dark patina

CREDITS

Yollocalli Arts Reach

Artist educator: Secret of Manna

STUDIO

ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013



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Mel Muniz
Michi Rechoncho
and Tomás
my life.





08 JARDIN DE GARGOLAS

Bring us a drawing, a model, or a hunch.

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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